

Europeans see deal as tilted toward U.S.

But E.U. negotiators say agreement was the best way to avert a trade war

BY ELLEN FRANCIS AND ANTHONY FAIOLA

BRUSSELS — The tariff-and-spending accord announced Sunday by the United States and the European Union stands to avert a damaging trade war between two of the world's largest economies, but it is lopsided in favor of President Donald Trump's protectionist policies, with Brussels swallowing bitter concessions in hopes of stabilizing a relationship that is vital not just economically but also for security interests.

The rough agreement — which allows Washington to raise tariffs on E.U. goods while the Europeans promise to buy more U.S. products — quickly came under sharp criticism in Europe. Despite feisty rhetoric and vows to stand up to Trump, E.U. leaders largely acquiesced to the U.S. leader's ever-changing demands.

E.U. negotiators insisted the deal was the best way to avoid a highly damaging tit-for-tat trade war that would benefit rivals such as China and Russia. But European officials and analysts said the tentative agreement does not end the uncertainty because so many details must still be worked out.

To the harshest critics, including some in France who spoke of a “capitulation” and “humiliation,” the agreement is proof of a deeply

SEE TRADE ON A15

The soft power of a traveling influencer

Nations aim to boost their image by showing a streamer a good time

BY DREW HARWELL

When the YouTube mega-streamer IShowSpeed walked shirtless last week off a private jet into the Lithuanian capital of Vilnius, the nation's economy minister was waiting for him on the tarmac with shots of saltibarsciai, a cold pink beetroot soup.

A mob of chanting fans was waiting, too, so the streamer — a 20-year-old from Cincinnati named Darren Watkins Jr., who has 120 million followers across TikTok, Instagram and YouTube — piled with his security detail into a minibus to drive to the city's historic Palace of the Grand Dukes, where the mayor served him cheese and honey and a troupe of young Lithuanian women taught him a traditional folk dance.

“These lyrics are about stabbing someone in the heart,” one woman said, with a smile.

Speed, as his fans call him, had become famous during the pandemic for his hyperactive, hours-long broadcasts, where he'd rage about video games, leap over Lamborghinis and perform unprompted backflips. But lately, his real star power has come from his international tours, during which he blitzes into foreign

SEE STREAMER ON A20



AN RONG XU/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Chinese tourists take photos on Long Beach, a short boat ride from Palau's Malakal Harbor, which the U.S. plans to upgrade for Navy ships. Elsewhere, radar sites are planned. But the arrival of Chinese developments has officials worried about surveillance.

A suspect juxtaposition in the Pacific

U.S. military sites in Palau end up in the shadow of Chinese hotels, some with questionable ties

BY MICHAEL E. MILLER, LYRIC LI AND AN RONG XU

KOROR, PALAU — The U.S. military will next year upgrade Palau's main harbor, usually frequented by dive boats full of tourists heading to emerald lagoons, so that American warships can enter the Pacific island nation's narrow channels and dock here.

The wharf will be expanded and elevated. There will be a new logistics hub with a

warehouse, enabling U.S. Navy ships to refuel, reload and rearm.

This is all part of a broader effort to boost the U.S. military's presence in the Western Pacific, allowing for the rapid mobilization of American forces in the event of a conflict involving China.

Complicating that plan, however, is a Chinese-owned hotel overlooking Malakal Harbor that U.S. and Palauan officials worry could be used for surveillance.

Across Palau, Chinese businesses and

developers have leased land near a half-dozen strategic locations where the United States is beefing up efforts to detect and deter China's growing reach into the region, according to intelligence and security documents and interviews with 20 American, Palauan and Taiwanese officials.

A months-long Washington Post investigation found that Chinese businesses have leased land or built properties for tourism developments near the port, the airport, a

SEE PALAU ON A10

New whistleblower challenges judicial nominee

BY PERRY STEIN AND THEODORIC MEYER

A new whistleblower has come forward to challenge the federal judicial nomination of Emil Bove, sharing evidence with lawmakers suggesting the controversial former attorney for Donald Trump and current top Justice Department official misled lawmakers during his confirmation hearing last month.

Emil Bove faces more allegations that he misled Congress at hearing

The whistleblower — whose existence has not been previously reported — presented documentation that contradicts claims Bove made before the Senate

Judiciary Committee about a Justice Department prosecution. The Washington Post reviewed the evidence and agreed to withhold details to protect the identity of the whistleblower, whose lawyers spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the whistleblower's fear of retribution.

Trump formally nominated Bove for a seat on the U.S. Court of Appeals for the 3rd Circuit in June and a full Senate vote is

expected this week — a faster timeline than most other judicial nominations.

The information follows revelations from two other Justice Department whistleblowers who have said that Bove told subordinates in a meeting in March that they may need to ignore court orders that would hamper Trump's campaign to deport millions of undocumented immi-

SEE BOVE ON A4



JEHAD ALSHRAFI/AP

Gaza receives airdropped aid

Humanitarian aid is airdropped to Palestinians over Gaza City on Monday, two days after Israel said it would loosen its policies on letting aid into the enclave under mounting international pressure. Two Israeli rights groups on Monday accused Israel's government of genocide in Gaza. **Story, A12**

Netanyahu buys time on Gaza by allowing in aid

Knesset's recess gives him political space as he delays strategic decisions

BY SHIRA RUBIN AND LIOR SOROKA

TEL AVIV — Under mounting international pressure, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu took advantage this past weekend of a small political window at home to step up humanitarian aid to Gaza, where deaths due to malnutrition are surging.

Netanyahu waited until Saturday, when two of his most hawkish coalition partners observe the Jewish Sabbath, to convene a meeting of his security cabinet and then green-light deliveries of aid to the Gaza Strip while also ordering a pause in some fighting in three areas to allow the assistance to proceed.

Trump tees up politics, business

GOLF CLUB BECOMES DIPLOMATIC VENUE

Personal interests, world affairs mix in Scotland

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI AND EMILY DAVIES

EDINBURGH, SCOTLAND — President Donald Trump has transformed the private green at his Turnberry golf course into a venue for high-stakes diplomacy.

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer met Monday morning with the president near the fairway to hash out a trade deal and discuss the wars in Gaza and Ukraine. On Sunday, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen announced the contours of a trade deal at the private club.

The meetings provide the latest example of how Trump uses his presidential power not only to govern, but also to help his family businesses. The engagements provide publicity for the courses and funnel taxpayer funds to the Trump Organization, as the U.S. government pays to lodge staff and security details at the properties.

“If you take a look at the windows in the various dining rooms, they're magnificent,” Trump said during his meeting with Starmer in a minutes-long aside to discuss his property.

“It's absolutely magnificent,” said Starmer, who has gone to great lengths to win the president's favor. “Both inside and out and looking at the courses itself and the building.”

Traditionally, American presidents are invited to other countries by their leaders and hosted at diplomatic residences. But Trump is playing host to Starmer in the prime minister's own country, continuing his long tradition of sidestepping presidential norms to mix his family business and his public office.

“It is an unusual dynamic, but

SEE TRUMP ON A15

Ukraine: President cuts Russia's deadline to reach ceasefire. **A13**

IN THE NEWS

Manhattan mass killing Four people were killed, including an NYPD officer, after a gunman opened fire in an office building. **A4**

D.C. Council passes budget Lawmakers wrestled with last-minute amendments to the nearly \$22 billion spending plan, and also advanced a housing bill. **B13**

THE NATION **Vice President JD Vance** pitched the “Big Beautiful Bill” to Ohio steelworkers. **A2** **Former Epstein associate Ghislaine Maxwell** sought a high court hearing on her appeal. **A6**

THE WORLD **Deadly wildfires** have killed at least 17 and forced evacuations in Turkey and Greece. **A8** **The sister of North Korea's leader** rejected attempts at dialogue from the South. **A13**

THE ECONOMY **Democrats expressed** “grave concern” to the commerce secretary over approval of Nvidia chip sales to China. **A14**

STYLE **At a two-day festival**, a handful of critically reviled bands explored the limits of alt-rock nostalgia. **B1**

SPORTS **A relief pitcher** for the Cleveland Guardians is the latest player to be investigated in a baseball gambling probe. **B7** **Nicklas Backstrom**, the former Capitals star, signed a one-year contract to play for a team in his native Sweden next season. **B7**

THE REGION **The Justice Department** said it would investigate a Faculty Senate resolution praising George Mason University's president. **B13**

OBITUARIES **Morton Mintz**, 103, was a pioneer in consumer affairs journalism for The Post. **B13**

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